Wednesday: Working in Groups

- Daily Check-In
- Warm-up: wordle, contexto, sets game
- Group activity: Pass the conversation ball
    - make sure everyone is listening to one another and taking turns
- "We just did a fun warm-up getting to know each other a little better, but that conversation ball actually connects to something really important we're going to talk about today: working in groups.
- No matter what you choose to do after high school, whether you go to college, go straight into a job, or live on your own in the community, you are going to need to work in groups and collaborate with other people. This isn't just a 'school skill.' It shows up everywhere:
- **In school** — group projects, class discussions, working with classmates, sports teams, clubs
- **At work** — teaming up with coworkers, taking direction from a boss, working alongside customers or clients
- **In the community** — living with roommates, working with neighbors, being part of clubs, teams, or community groups
- So today, we're going to focus on four key things that help us work well in a group, no matter which setting we're in:
- **Listen first** — look toward the person talking, and don't start talking over them
- **Wait for a turn** — let one person talk at a time
- **Stay on topic** — say something that connects to what's already being discussed
- **Share, don't take over** — say your piece, then let someone else have a turn

- you actually already practiced these four skills without even realizing it, during the conversation ball warm-up. Every time you waited for the ball, listened to the person holding it, and then added something that connected to what they said, you were using these exact group skills.
- That's the goal for today: to notice these skills when we're using them, and to start thinking about how you'll use them not just here in class, but in whatever comes next after high school: college, a job, or life in your community."

"Let's make this a little more real, here are some examples of what working in a group might actually look like in each of these settings.

In school:

- Working with a partner or small group on a class project
- Being part of a class discussion where everyone takes turns sharing ideas
- Working with a lab partner in science class

At work:

- Splitting up tasks with coworkers to get a job done faster
- Listening to feedback or instructions from a supervisor
- Working as a team during a busy shift — like at a restaurant, store, or warehouse

In the community:

- Living with a roommate and figuring out chores or shared space together
- Being part of a team, club, or volunteer group
- Working with neighbors on something like a block cleanup or a shared project

- Notice something ,in every single one of these examples, you'd need to use our four skills: listening first, waiting for your turn, staying on topic, and sharing without taking over. It doesn't matter if you're in a classroom, on a job site, or just living your life in your community , these skills go with you everywhere."